

DIGITAL FORENSICS TOOL · USER GUIDE

DECIPHER-iKakao

Decrypting & analyzing KakaoTalk messages from encrypted iOS backups

Windows

Standalone .exe

English Edition

Regular chat & OpenChat · deleted-message recovery · attachments & downloaded files

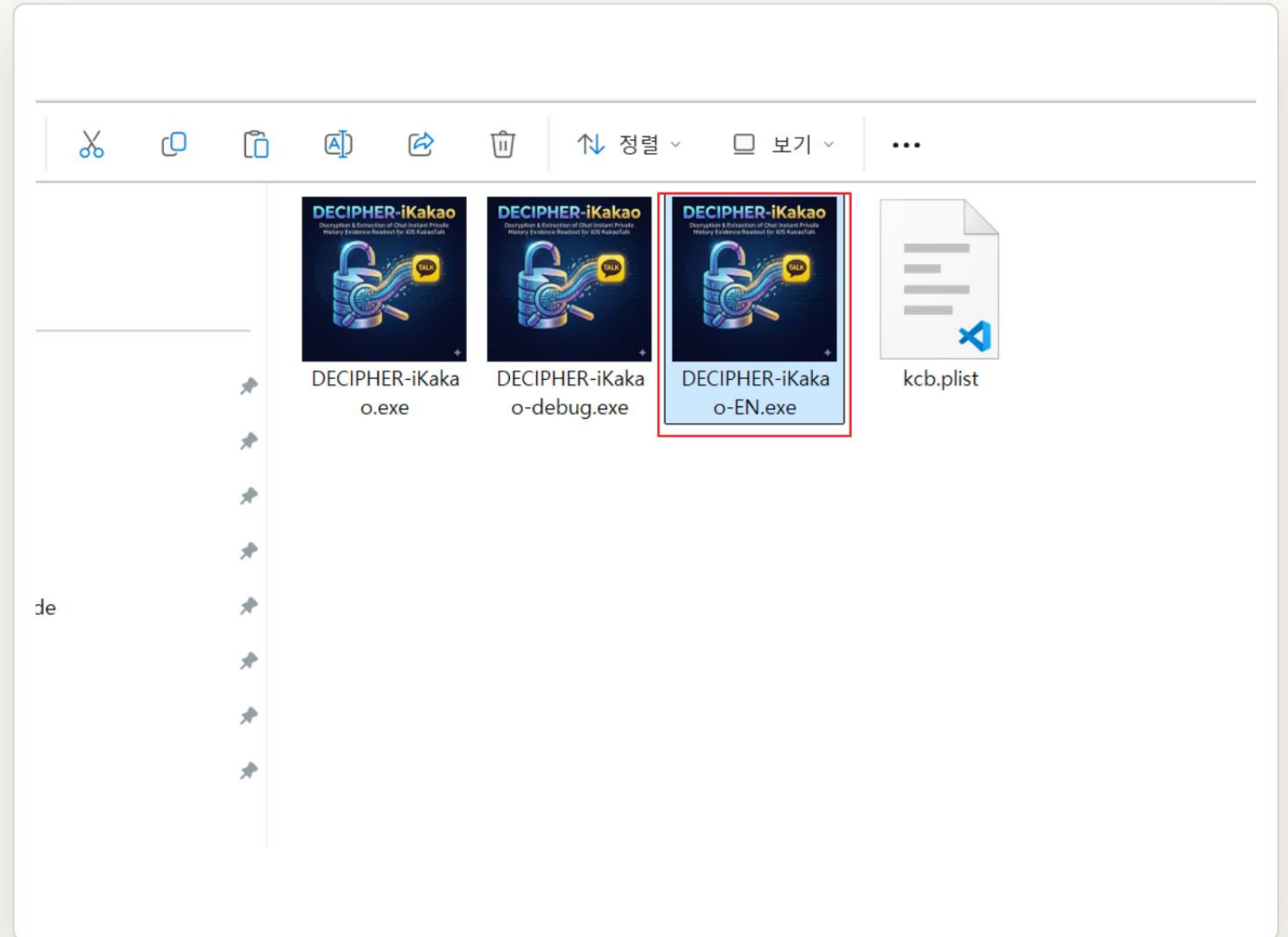
STEP 01 · LAUNCH

01

Launch the English build

Run the standalone executable — no installation required.

Double-click `DECIPHER-iKakao-EN.exe` in the `dist` folder.



STEP 02 · BACKUP

02

Create an encrypted iTunes backup

Back up the iPhone to this computer in Finder / iTunes.

Enable **Encrypt local backup**, set a password, then click **Back Up Now**.

iPhone X

Capacity: 59.51GB
Phone Number: None
Serial Number: C39VQAXDJCLJ

iOS 16.7.12

A newer version of iPhone software is available (version 16.7.16). To update your iPhone with the latest software, click Update.

Update

Restore iPhone...

Backup

Automatic Backup

☐ iCloud

Back up most of the important data on your iPhone to iCloud.

☒ This Computer

A full backup of your iPhone will be stored on this computer.

☒ **Encrypt local backup**

When checked, account passwords, Health, and HomeKit data will be backed up.

Change Password...

Manually Back Up and Restore

Manually back up your iPhone to this computer, or restore a backup stored on this computer.

Back Up Now

Restore Backup

Latest Backup:

On this computer: June 2, 2026, 2:38 PM

STEP 03 · LOCATE

03

Find the backup folder

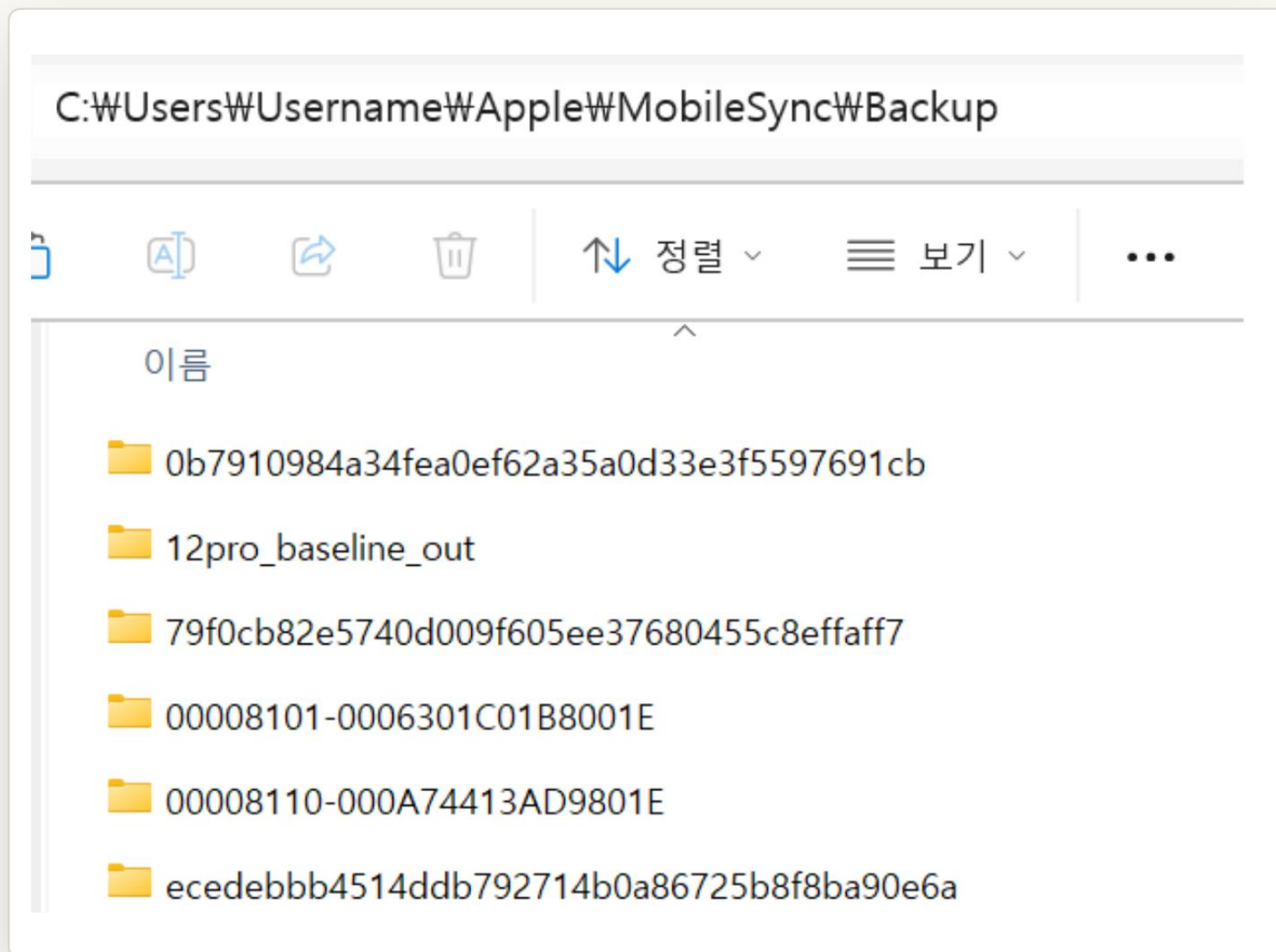
Windows stores device backups under MobileSync.

Path:

..\Apple\MobileSync\Backup\<UDID>.

Each UDID folder is one backup and holds

Manifest.db.



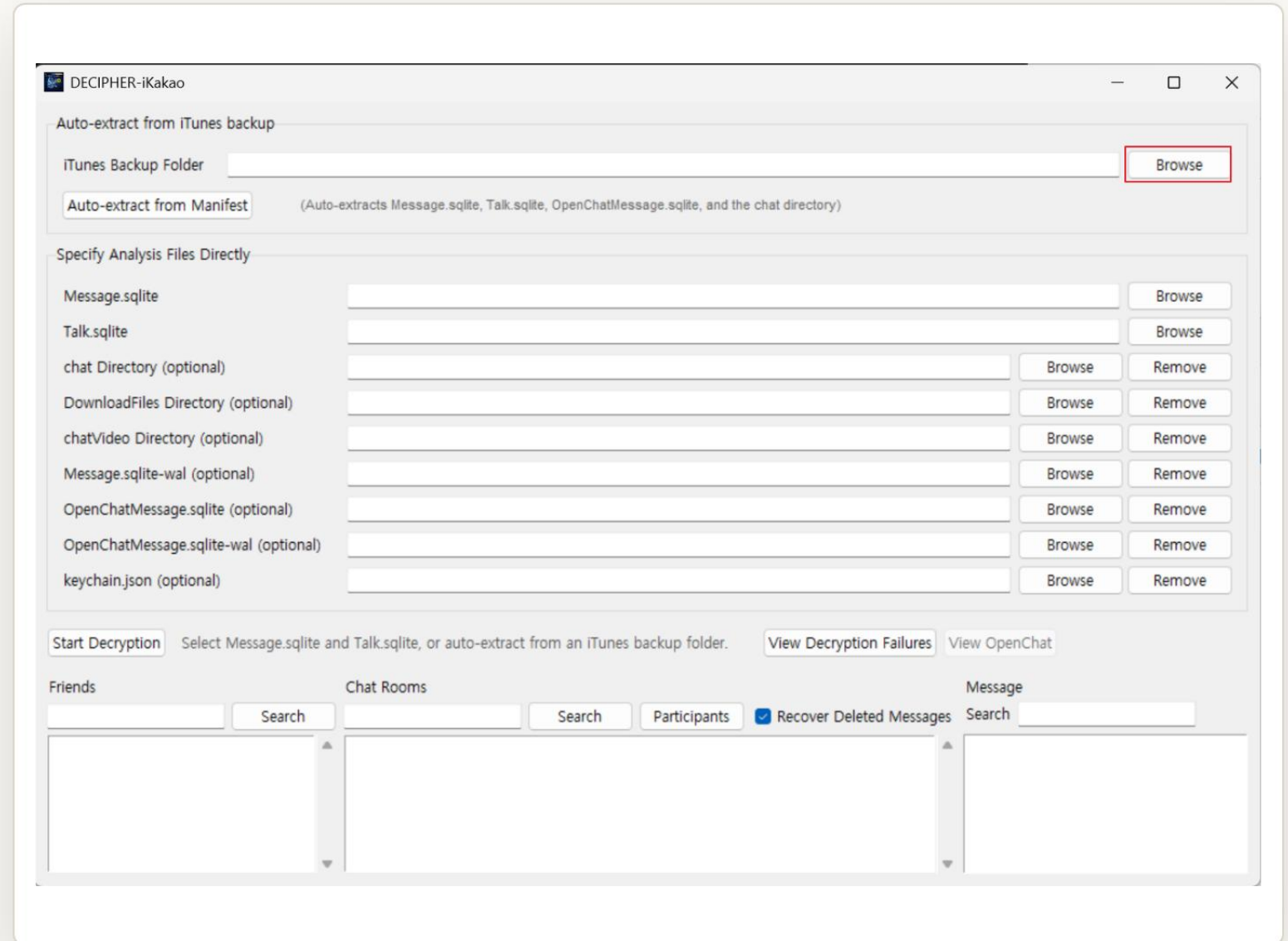
STEP 04 · LOAD

04

Load the backup into the tool

Open the main window and point it at the backup.

Under **Auto-extract from iTunes backup**, click **Browse** beside `iTunes Backup Folder` and select the UDID folder.



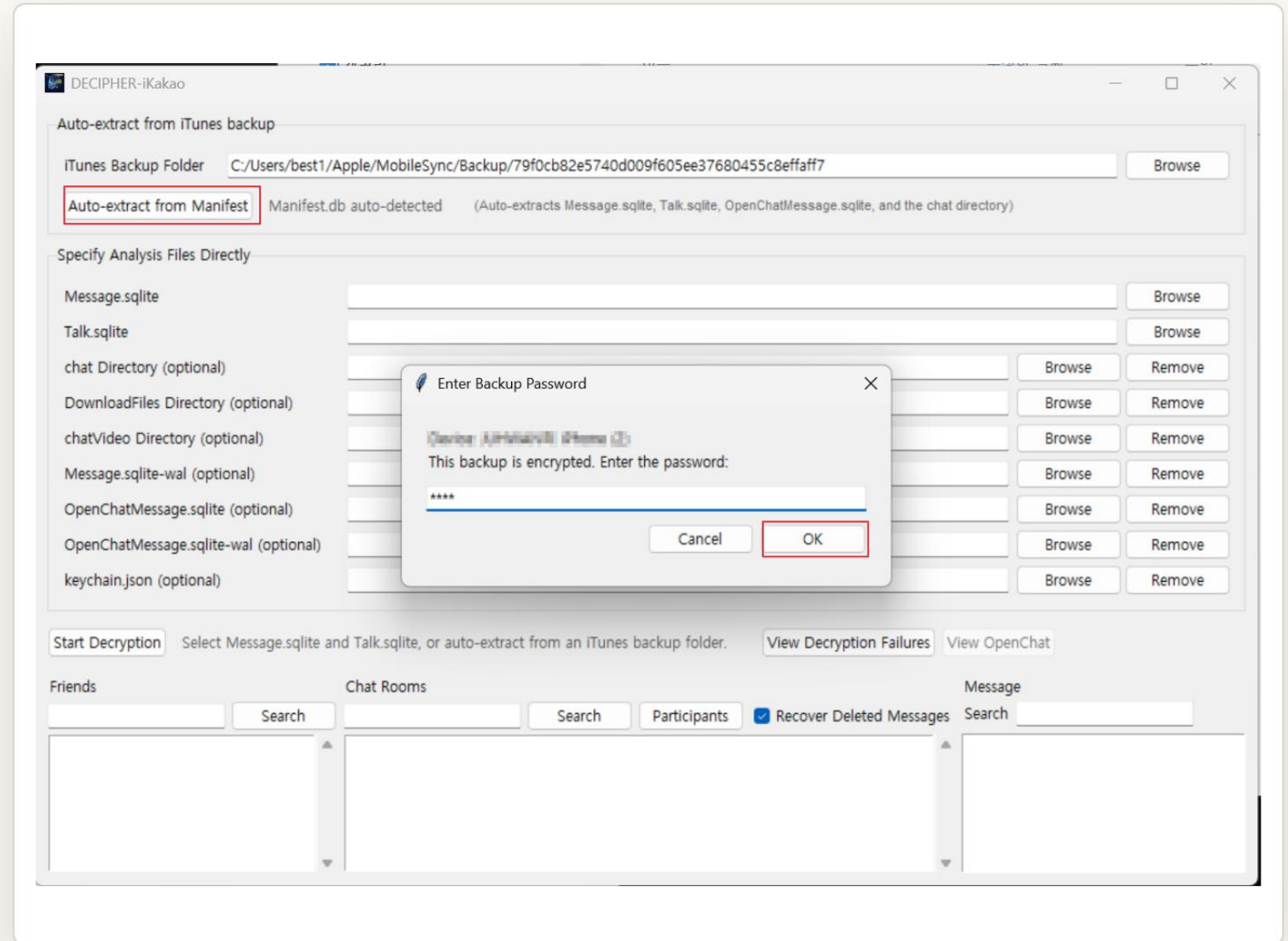
STEP 05 · EXTRACT

05

Auto-extract & enter password

Extract the KakaoTalk databases from the backup.

Click **Auto-extract from Manifest**. When prompted, type the backup password and click **OK**.



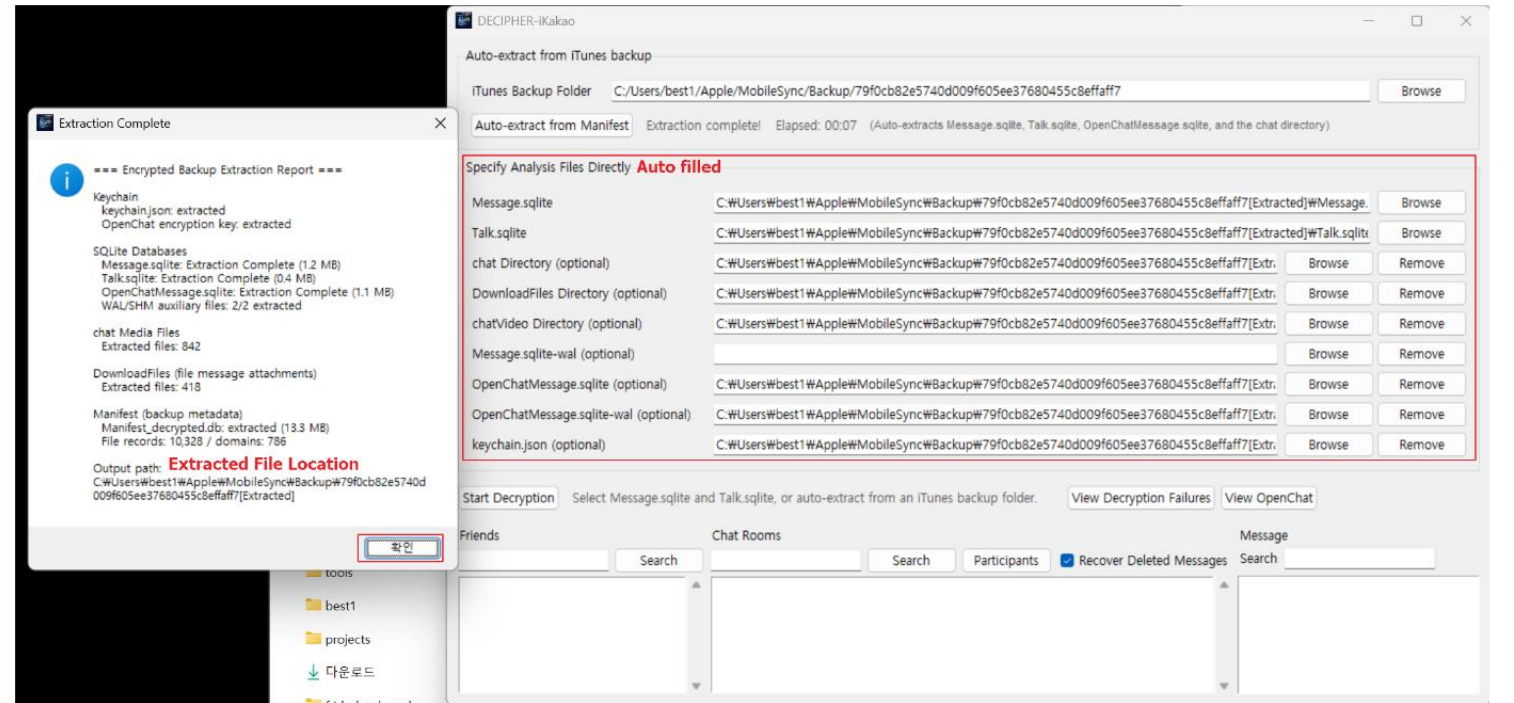
STEP 06 · REPORT

06

Extraction complete

A report lists every artifact that was recovered.

Keychain, Message.sqlite, Talk.sqlite and OpenChatMessage.sqlite are extracted; the file fields auto-fill.



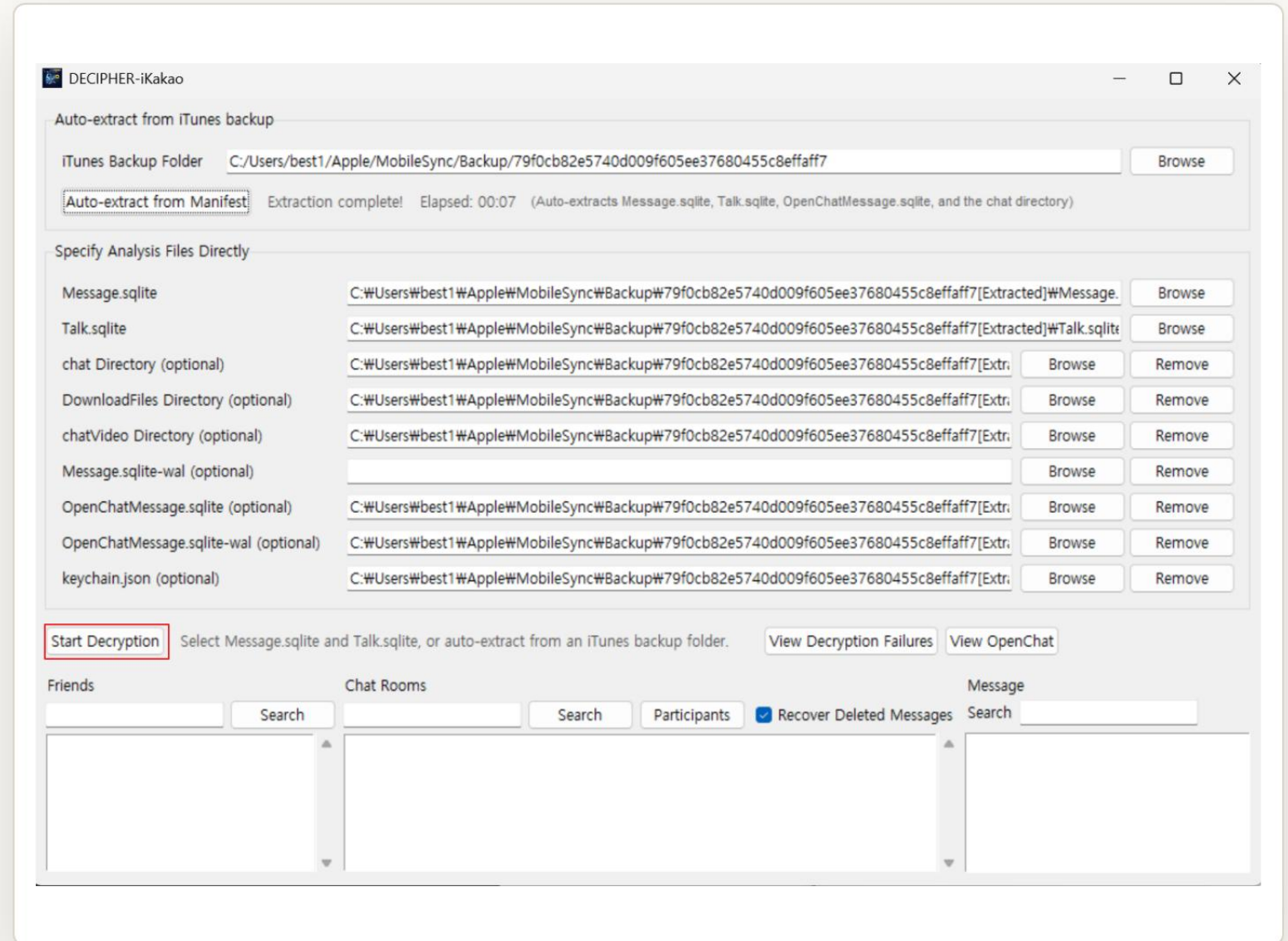
STEP 07 · DECRYPT

07

Run decryption

Decrypt the extracted databases.

Optionally tick **Recover Deleted Messages**, then click **Start Decryption**.



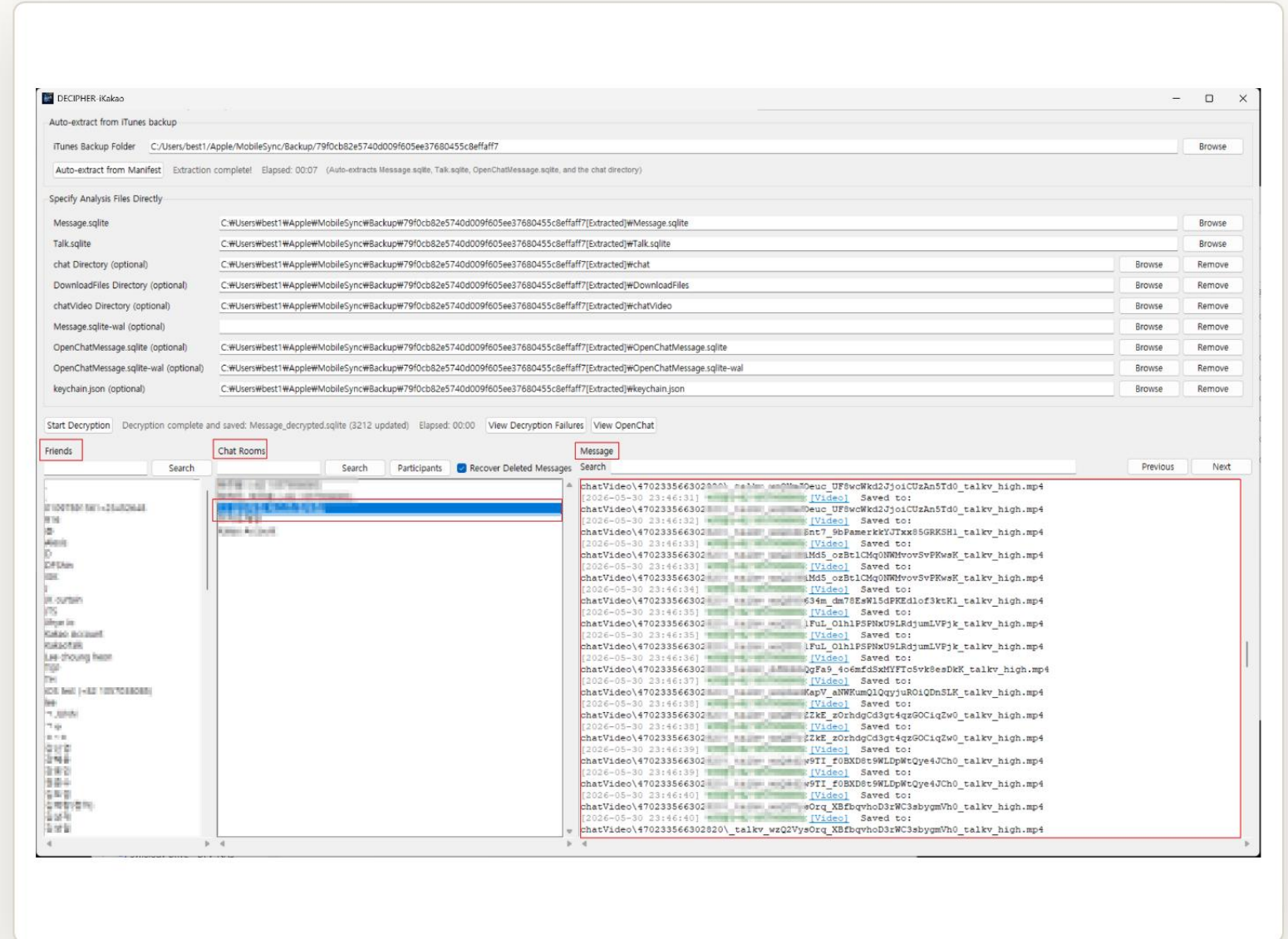
STEP 08 · REVIEW

08

Browse decrypted messages

Read conversations with timestamps and attachments.

Select a room in **Chat Rooms** to load it under **Message**. Use **Friends**, **Search** and **Participants**.



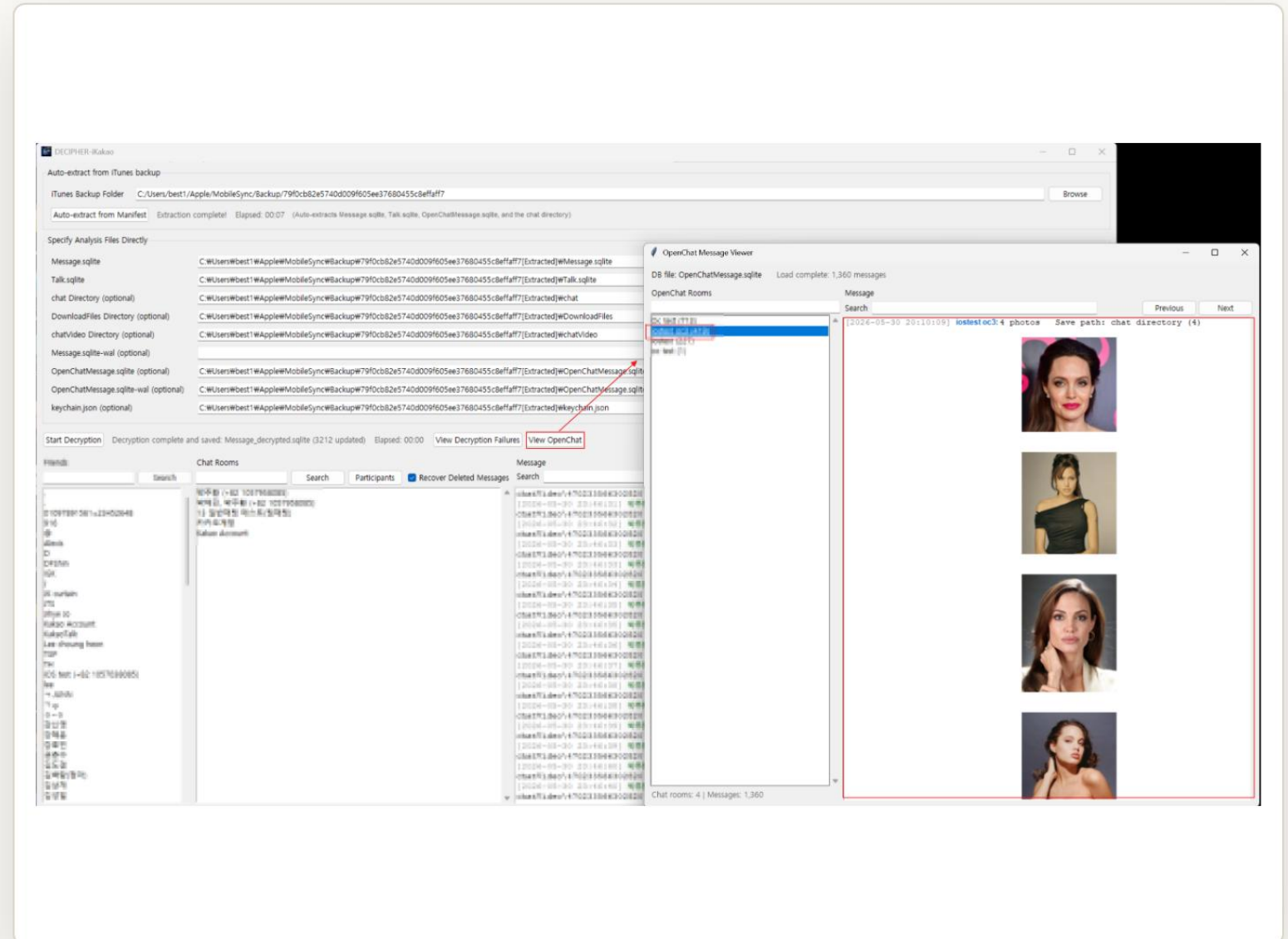
STEP 09 · OPENCHAT

09

View OpenChat messages

Decrypt and read OpenChat (SQLCipher) rooms.

Click **View OpenChat** to open the OpenChat Message Viewer. Multi-photo messages render inline.



STEP 10 · MEDIA

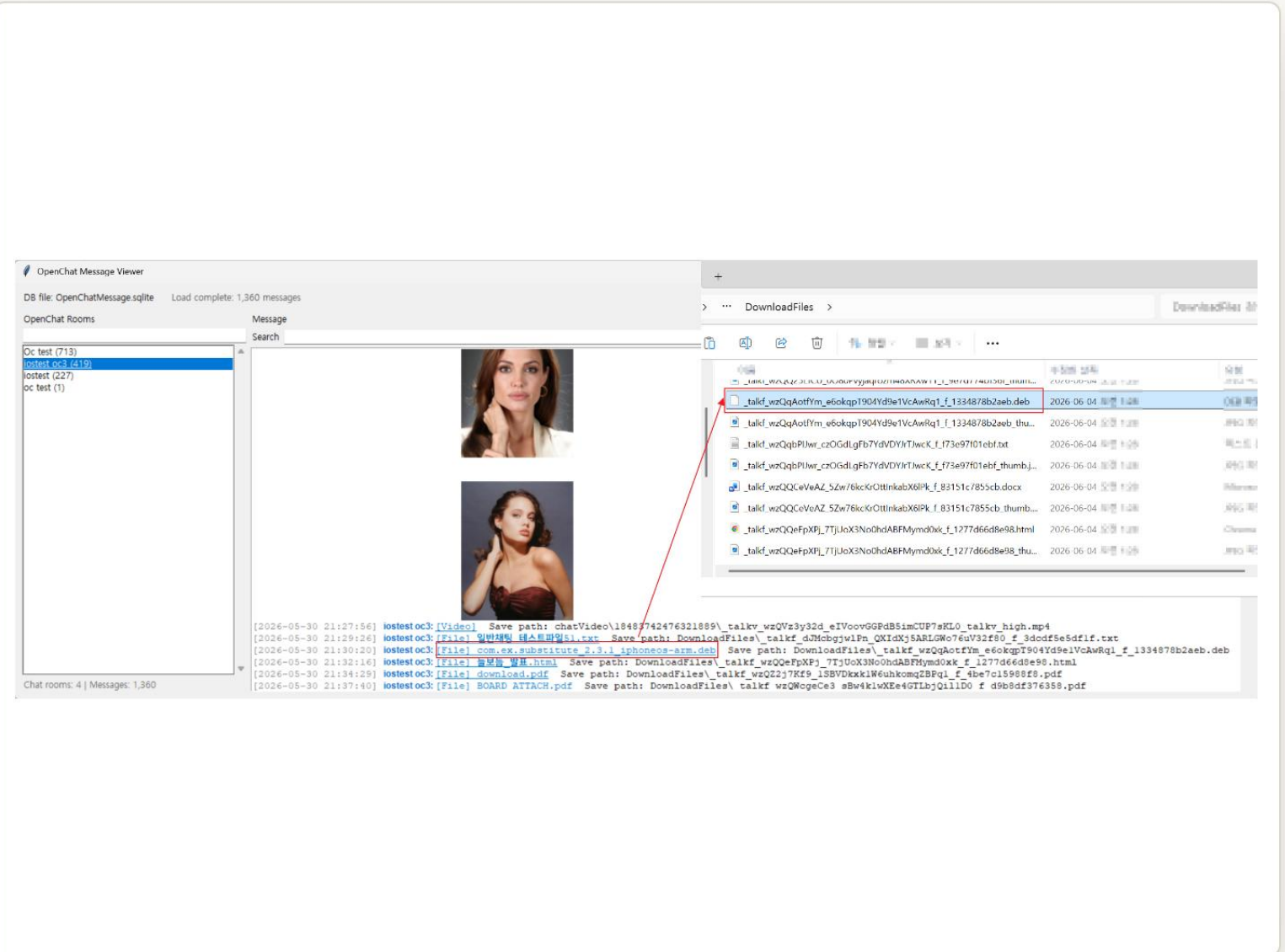
10

Jump to saved media

Trace any attachment to its file on disk.

Click a sent or received photo, file, or video to open its saved location in the

`DownloadFiles` folder.



REFERENCE

Forensic integrity

- **Identical engine.** Byte-for-byte equivalent in logic to the original build — only the interface language differs.
- **Evidence preserved.** Recovered message text is shown verbatim in its original language; content is never translated.
- **Deleted-message recovery.** “Deleted on this device only” messages are restored from the SQLite Freelist and WAL snapshots.
- **Nothing hidden.** Messages that cannot be decrypted are listed under **Decryption Failures**, never dropped.